

condition.



HEARING AIDS

Beethoven tried to mitigate his failing hearing using ear trumpets designed by his friend Johann Nepomuk Mälzel, also the inventor of the metronome.

From around 1812, there was a sharp, but temporary, falling off in his creativity and he had to give up performance. By 1818, he could only converse in writing. The advance of deafness led to increasing isolation and unstable behavior. Rooms in which he lived or worked degenerated into disorderly squalor. He was often described as ill-mannered, unkempt, and bad-tempered. After the death of his brother Kaspar in 1815, he became involved in a vicious dispute with his sister-in-law